

Patisserie Around the World

Throughout German-speaking lands, afternoon *Kaffee und Kuchen* (coffee and cake) has become a sophisticated social ritual that demands lavish surroundings and ornate *torten*.

SALZBURG

Café Tomaselli

Alter Markt 9; www.tomaselli.at

Austria's oldest coffeehouse, founded in 1705, was once the haunt of Mozart and prides itself on barely having changed since then. The *torten* are outstanding, but the place prides itself on its *Guglhupf*, a simple marble cake.

Café Fürst

Brodgasse 13; www.original-mozartkugel.com

The upmarket coffeehouse opposite Café Tomaselli invented the ubiquitous marzipan "Mozart Ball" in 1890. It has many delicious *torten* and some lovely outdoor seating on the square outside.

Fingerlos

Franz Josef Strasse 9; +43 662 874 213

This is the locals' choice for coffee and cake: a little off the beaten path, but well worth the effort for its broad selection of freshly made, high-quality *torten* and the lively and contemporary atmosphere.

Konditorei Zauner

Pfarrgasse 7, Bad Ischl; www.zauner.at

Located in Salzburg's hinterland spa town of Bad Ischl, the glittering chandeliers, marble floors, and fantastical confectionery of this patisserie are a draw for the entire region. It began life in the early 19th century as a supplier to the Austrian royal family.

VIENNA, AUSTRIA

The Viennese claim that they invented the notion of afternoon coffee and cake, and they certainly have enough venerable cafés and patisseries, or *Konditoreien*, to help prove it.

Hotel Sacher

Schwarzstrasse 5–7 and Philharmonikerstrasse 4; www.sacher.com

The Sacher hotel chain is a legacy of the pastry chef who invented the Sacher Torte, and it has branches

in Salzburg and Vienna. Both have slightly snooty cafés with deep-red upholstery, liveried tableware, and arguably the best Sacher Torte in the world.

Café Central

Corner of Strauchgasse/Herrengasse; www.cafecentral-wien.at

The favorite coffeehouse of Sigmund Freud and Leon Trotsky (in exile) is still steeped in Viennese tradition with tuxedoed waiters, extravagant chandeliers, and locals poring over newspapers. The setting, ambience, and unique *torten* often make it very busy, but it's spacious enough to cope.

Demel

Kohlmarkt 14; www.demel.at

A fine, long-standing Viennese coffee house that opened as an aristocrats' playground in 1786. It is best known for its Sacher Torte, which was first made here by Eduard Sacher (son of Franz, its inventor), sparking a legal contest within the family. The café today is more exceptional for its many coffees and extraordinary multicolored *torten*, which have included waxwork-style recreations of celebrities. It also has branches in Salzburg and New York.

Konditorei Heiner

Wollzeile 9; www.heiner.co.at

A popular local café chain with several Viennese branches, including this cozy wood-paneled one on Wollzeile. Reasonable prices belie the superb quality and the pedigree of this bakery, which once supplied the Austrian court. The succulent poppy-seed *torte* is in a league of its own.

BLACK FOREST, GERMANY

The namesake of the famous Black Forest cake, this region of southwest Germany loves to celebrate fine foods and its heritage, be it in the form of cuckoo clocks, traditional dress, wooden farmhouses, or delicious *torten*.

Café König

Lichtentaler Strasse 12, Baden-Baden; www.chocolatier.de

This is a stylish throwback to Baden-Baden's 18th-century heyday, as depicted in the black-and-white prints that line the café walls. Elderly ladies in extravagant hats adore its famously delicate Black Forest cake; the fruit *torten* are also superb.

